Sustainability Training

Building Strong, Independent Communities

What is sustainability training?

Sustainability training helps communities and organizations **stay strong and keep working** by finding ways to support their projects for the long term.

It means your project can continue helping people even when outside help ends.

Four ways to build sustainability

1	2	3	4
Making Money	Social Business	Community Help	Different Sources

1. Making money (Income generation)

What does this mean?

Creating activities that bring in money:

- Selling products or services
- Charging small fees for programs
- Renting out space or equipment

Why it helps

Your project becomes more independent and does not have to wait for donations to do its work.

Real example

A women's group in Kenya:

They used to depend on donations. Now they:

- Make and sell handmade baskets
- Sell them at the local market
- Earn $400 per month

This money pays for:

✓ Materials to keep working
✓ Meeting space rent
✓ Small salaries for members

2. Social business (Social enterprise)

What is it?

A business that:

- Solves a community problem
- Earns money at the same time

Two goals in one:

1. Help the community
2. Make money to keep going

Real example

A health center in Uganda:

The Problem:
People get sick from dirty water

The Solution:
They sell water filters at low cost

Results:
✓ Families have clean water
✓ Money earned pays staff salaries
✓ Center stays open without donations

3. Community help (Community fundraising)

Getting support from your own community

Collecting help and resources from local people and partners. This makes people feel like the project belongs to them too.

People Care More

When they give, they want the project to succeed

Local Ownership

Community feels it is their project, not an outsider's

More Stable

Many small supporters are stronger than one big donor

Ways to get community help

Local fundraising events

Hold events where people pay to join and have fun

Example: A school holds a fun run. People pay $5 to run. They raise $2,000 for new books.

Membership programs

Ask people to join and pay a small fee every month or year

Example: A library asks members to pay $10 per year. 200 members = $2,000 per year.

Community contributions

Ask local businesses and people to donate what they can

4. Different sources (Diversified funding)

What does this mean?

Getting money from many different places instead of depending on just one source.

Different sources can include:

- Donations from individuals
- Grants from organizations
- Money from selling products
- Membership fees
- Event fundraisers

Why it matters

Think of it like a table with many legs:

If one leg breaks, the table still stands.

If you depend on only one donor:
✗ They might stop giving
✗ Your project stops

With many sources:
✓ If one stops, others continue
✓ Your project stays strong
✓ You are more independent

Example: How one group does it

Community youth center in Rwanda

Their funding comes from 5 different sources:

Individual Donations	**$3,000**	30%
Government Grant	**$2,500**	25%
Selling Crafts	**$2,000**	20%
Membership Fees	**$1,500**	15%
Event Fundraisers	**$1,000**	10%
TOTAL BUDGET	**$10,000**	

Building your sustainability plan

Steps to become sustainable

1. **Start small income activity**
   Sell something or offer a service
2. **Get community involved**
   Ask local people to help and contribute
3. **Find different money sources**
   Don't depend on just one donor
4. **Grow your social business**
   Help community while earning money

Key Takeaways

- ✓ **Start activities that make money** to become independent
- ✓ **Create social businesses** that help people and earn money
- ✓ **Get your community involved** so they feel ownership
- ✓ **Use many different funding sources** to stay strong

Sustainability means your project can help people for many years to come